Training and Research

Work Package 17 | Leads: Executive Director (UNITAR), Rector (UNU)

OBJECTIVE

To make the UN system's training and research activities more coherent, more integrated and more useful.

HOW WE GET THERE

- **Action 68: Merge UNSSC into UNITAR** to create a more coherent and efficient system-wide training and capacity-building offer for UN system personnel and Member States.
- **Action 69: Integrate UNRISD into UNU** to better align research, strengthen policy relevance and impact.
- **Action 72: Establish a joint coordination mechanism** to improve coordination of training and research activities across the wider UN system.

PROGRESS TO DATE

For the proposed merger of UNSSC into UNITAR, a structured design process is under way, supported by outside expertise and consultations with Boards, Member States, UN system staff and other stakeholders. For the proposed integration of UNRISD into UNU, consultations on the arrangements are being undertaken, including with the UNRISD Board and the UNU Council. For the coordination mechanism, mapping of training and research functions is complete and a blueprint for the mechanism has been developed.

NEXT STEPS AND DECISIONS

- **Action 68:** A draft merger proposal will be ready by May, for consideration by the **Boards** of UNITAR and UNSSC in **June**. It will be transmitted to the Secretary-General as the basis for his report in **July** to the **General Assembly** with a view to a decision during the **eightieth session**.
- **Action 69:** An initial integration proposal will be ready for consideration by the UNRISD **Board** and UNU **Council** in **May** and **June**, respectively. The outcome will be submitted to the Secretary-General for decision. Integration would additionally require a UNU Council decision to establish UNRISD as a UNU institute. Any required revision of the Secretary-General's Bulletin (UNRISD) would follow. No decision of an intergovernmental organ is envisaged.
- **Action 72:** The joint system-wide coordination mechanism is being developed by UNU and UNITAR, with a proposed blueprint to be submitted for the Secretary-General's consideration in May. An information brief for Member States will follow in **July**. No decision of an intergovernmental organ is envisaged.

QUICK SUMMARY: PATHWAYS AND PRODUCTS

Action	Pathway to decision	Products (dates)	Intergovernmental consideration
Action 68: Merge UNSSC into UNITAR	Work package lead → Boards → Secretary-General → General Assembly	• **Secretary-General's report** (July)	For General Assembly decision (eightieth session)
Action 69: Integrate UNRISD into UNU	Work package lead → Governing bodies → Secretary-General → UNU Council	• **Secretary-General's information brief** (July)	-
Action 72: Establish joint coordination mechanism	Work package leads → Secretary-General	• **Secretary-General's information brief** (July)	-